

Uncovering the Unwritten Rules of an Organization

Think about a place where you worked before - or a club or student group you have been a part of at UNC Asheville; ideally somewhere that you were involved for at least 6 months. Answer the following questions:

1. What was the attire expected? How were you supposed to dress?
2. Who called meetings? Were you allowed to call a meeting?
3. How were big decisions made? Behind doors with a few people, collaboratively with the group, or another way?
4. How were small decisions made? Were you allowed to make small daily decisions?
5. Some organizations expect you to be early, others regularly start meetings 5 or more minutes late. What were the expectations about being on time?
6. If you couldn't make it to a commitment, what were you supposed to do? Who were you supposed to tell?
7. How did the group communicate? Primarily in person, through email, through text, or another way? Were you allowed to have the same access to people at all levels of the organization or did your boss have to ask their boss?

8. If you had a problem, were you supposed to try to solve it first or ask for help immediately? How did you find out what to do?
9. Does the organization expect you to pick up the phone when people call?
10. What type of behaviors did the most successful people in this organization demonstrate? What happened to members of the organization who behaved differently from the culture?
11. If no one told you the answers to all of these questions when you started with that organization, how did you find out?